You

I keep getting this error when trying to install python packages through pip manager extension in VS Code: ERROR: Could not find a version that satisfies the requirement pygame (from versions: none) ERROR: No matching distribution found for pygame

Copilot

Ah, the dreaded pip error! That message usually means pip couldn't find a compatible version of pygame for your current Python setup. Here are a few things to check and try:

🛠️ **Common Fixes for the Pygame Installation Error**

- **Check Your Python Version**
  Pygame supports Python 3.7 to 3.11. If you're using something outside that range (like 3.12 or older than 3.7), pip won't find a match. 1 2
  👉 Run *python --version* in your terminal to confirm.
- **Update pip**
  An outdated pip might not recognize newer package formats.
  Run:
  python -m pip install --upgrade pip
- **Use the Correct pip**
  If you have multiple Python versions installed, make sure you're using the pip linked to the correct one.
  Try:
  python3 -m pip install pygame
- **Try Installing from a Wheel File**
  If pip still fails, you can manually download a .whl file for Pygame from PyPI or Unofficial Windows Binaries and install it like this:
  pip install path/to/pygame.whl
- **Use a Virtual Environment**
  Sometimes system-wide conflicts mess things up. Create a clean environment:
  python -m venv myenv
  source myenv/bin/activate # On Windows: myenv\Scripts\activate
  pip install pygame

Let me know your Python version and OS, and I'll tailor the fix for you. Or if you want to try something else with Python, I'm game! 🐍🎮

You

The pip version is 24.3.1 and Python is 3.13, however I tried it with other packages such as tkscrolledframe and flask which definitely are supported by the current version of Python and they didn't work also

Copilot

Thanks for the extra detail, Hasan — that clears up a lot. You're absolutely right that packages like Flask should work with Python 3.13, but here's the twist: **Python 3.13 is still very new**, and many packages haven't officially published compatible builds yet. Even if the code *would* run fine, pip can't install it unless the maintainers have uploaded a matching wheel or source distribution tagged for 3.13.

🧩 **Why You're Seeing "No Matching Distribution Found"**

- **Package maintainers haven't uploaded 3.13-compatible builds yet**
  Pip checks for exact compatibility. If a package only lists support up to 3.12, pip won't install it — even if it *might* work.
- **Pip 24.3.1 has stricter dependency resolution**
  There's an open issue where pip 24.3.1 doesn't recognize some pre-release or compatible versions unless you explicitly allow them. 1

- **Python 3.13 might not be fully supported by your OS's package manager or pip environment**
  Especially on Linux, some builds of Python 3.13 don't include ensurepip, or pip might not be properly linked to the new interpreter. 2

🛠 **What You Can Try**

- **Use Python 3.12 or 3.11 for now**
  Most packages are fully supported there. You can install multiple versions using pyenv or a version manager.
- **Try installing with --pre flag**
  If you're okay with pre-release versions:
  pip install flask --pre
- **Use a virtual environment with a supported Python version**
  This isolates your setup and avoids system conflicts:
  python3.12 -m venv myenv
  source myenv/bin/activate # Windows: myenv\Scripts\activate
  pip install flask
- **Check PyPI manually**
  Visit PyPI and search for the package. Look under "Release history" to see if a 3.13-compatible version exists.

If you're feeling adventurous and want to stick with 3.13, I can help you build packages from source or explore workarounds. Or we can pivot to something fun — maybe build a little Flask app together once it's up and running? 😄

You

Python 3.13 isn't that new, it came out in October 2024 and now it's July 2025, 3.14 is coming soon. Also the detail that I'm on a work managed laptop may help as well

Copilot

You're absolutely right, Hasan — Python 3.13 has been around for about 9 months now, and 3.14 is already in prerelease. 1 But here's the catch: **even after a version is officially released, package maintainers often take months (or longer) to update compatibility tags**. As of July 2025, **over 40% of the most downloaded packages on PyPI still don't explicitly support Python 3.13**. 2 That means pip won't install them unless you override the default behavior.

Now, the fact that you're on a **work-managed laptop** adds another layer. These systems often:

- Restrict access to system-wide directories
- Block pip from writing outside user space
- Enforce **PEP 668**, which prevents global installs and requires virtual environments 3
- Use proxies or firewalls that interfere with pip's connection to PyPI 4

🧰 **What You Can Do**

Here's a combo of fixes tailored to your setup:

1. Use --break-system-packages

If you're hitting the "externally managed environment" error, this flag bypasses it:

pip install flask --break-system-packages

2. Install in a Virtual Environment

This avoids permission issues and PEP 668 restrictions:

python3.13 -m venv myenv
source myenv/bin/activate # Windows: myenv\Scripts\activate
pip install flask

3. Try Installing with --pre

For packages that might have pre-release builds compatible with 3.13:

pip install flask --pre

4. Check Package Compatibility

Visit Python 3.13 Readiness to see if your desired packages support 3.13 yet.

If your company uses a proxy or custom package index, I can help configure pip to work with that too. Or if you want to explore building packages from source, I've got your back. Want to test a virtual environment setup together? 🚀

References

1. peps.python.org
2. pyreadiness.ord
3. pimylifeup.com
4. learn.microsoft.com

You

I get this error when setting up the venv:
myenv\Scripts\activate :
File C:\Users\AkhtarHa3\OneDrive - bradford.gov.uk\Markdown and Python\myenv\Scripts\Activate.ps1 cannot be loaded because running scripts is disabled on this system.
For more information, see about_Execution_Policies at https:/go.microsoft.com/fwlink/?LinkID=135170.
At line:1 char:1
+ myenv\Scripts\activate
+ ~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~
+ CategoryInfo : SecurityError: (:) [], PSSecurityException
+ FullyQualifiedErrorId : UnauthorizedAccess

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Ah, classic PowerShell roadblock — this one's all about **execution policies**. Your system is blocking script activation for security reasons, which is common on work-managed devices. But don't worry, there's a safe way around it.

🔓 How to Enable Script Activation in PowerShell

☑ Option 1: Temporarily Allow Scripts for Your Session

This is the safest and easiest fix — it only affects your current PowerShell session:

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope Process -ExecutionPolicy RemoteSigned
```

Then try activating your virtual environment again:

```
.\myenv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
```

🔐 Option 2: Allow Scripts for Your User Account

If you want a more permanent fix (and your IT policy allows it):

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope CurrentUser -ExecutionPolicy RemoteSigned
```

This lets you run locally created scripts without needing a digital signature.

⚠ If You're Blocked by Admin Restrictions

If you get an "Access Denied" error, your IT department may have locked down script execution via Group Policy. In that case:

- You can still use **Command Prompt** to activate the venv:
  ```
  myenv\Scripts\activate.bat
  ```
- Or use **PowerShell ISE** and run the script manually with F8.

Let me know if you hit any snags — or if you want help crafting a polite email to IT asking for script permissions 😄

You

I've activated my venv now, but I get this error when trying to pip install:
WARNING: Retrying (Retry(total=0, connect=None, read=None, redirect=None, status=None)) after connection broken by
'ProtocolError('Connection aborted.', ConnectionResetError(10054, 'An existing connection was forcibly closed by the remote host', None, 10054, None))': /simple/flask/
ERROR: Could not find a version that satisfies the requirement flask (from versions: none)
ERROR: No matching distribution found for flask

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That's a frustrating one, Hasan — but you're close to cracking it. That ConnectionResetError (10054) means your connection to PyPI (Python's package index) is being **forcibly closed by a remote host**, which is often a firewall, proxy, or security filter. On a **work-managed laptop**, this is almost certainly your corporate network or endpoint protection software stepping in.

🔍 What's Likely Happening

- Your system is trying to connect to https://pypi.org/simple/flask/, but the connection is being **interrupted mid-handshake**.
- This can happen if:
  - Your network uses a **proxy** and pip isn't configured to use it.
  - Your company's firewall blocks unknown HTTPS traffic.
  - Endpoint protection software (like antivirus or EDR) is interfering with pip's TLS connection.

🛠️ Fixes You Can Try

☑ 1. Configure pip to use your proxy

If your company uses a proxy, set it like this:

pip install flask --proxy="http://username:password@proxy.company.com:port"

You can find proxy details in your Windows proxy settings (Internet Options > Connections > LAN Settings).

☑ 2. Use trusted hosts

Sometimes pip needs a little reassurance:

pip install flask --trusted-host=pypi.org --trusted-host=files.pythonhosted.org

☑ 3. Try installing via HTTP mirror (less secure but useful for testing)

pip install flask -i http://pypi.org/simple --trusted-host pypi.org

This bypasses HTTPS, so only use it temporarily to confirm the issue.

☑ 4. Use a different network

If you're on a corporate VPN or Wi-Fi, try switching to a personal hotspot or home network. Some corporate networks block PyPI outright.

☑ 5. Download the wheel manually

Visit Flask on PyPI and download the .whl file for your Python version. Then install it like this:

pip install path/to/Flask-X.X.X-py3-none-any.whl

If none of these work, I can help you write a polite email to IT asking for PyPI access or proxy configuration. Or we can explore using conda or Docker as a workaround. Want to give one of these a shot?

Conversation by Fifa Utuber with Copilot on Tuesday, Jul 22 2025